Hall of Westminster on the twenty-sixth birthday of the League on 10 January 1946.

The agenda for the sessions of the General Assembly revolves around the isssues of International Peace and Security, Economic Growth and Sustainable Development, Development of Africa, Human Rights, Humanitarian and Disaster Relief Assistance, Justice and International Law, Disarmament, Drugs, Crime, International Terrorism, Organizational and Administrative Matters.

Besides the regular sessions, the General Assembly can also meet in special sessions which “shall be convoked by the Secretary-General at the request of the Security Council or of a majority of the Members of the United Nations”. [Chapter IV, Article 20]

Any member state can also request the Secretary-General to summon a special session. On receipt of such a request, the Secretary-General immediately informs the other members of the UN of the request and makes sure that there is a general concurrence in the Assembly on the particular matter to be debated. If within thirty days from the date of communication to the Secretary-General, it is found that a majority of the members concur with the request, then a special session of the General Assembly can be summoned.

Several special sessions of the Assembly have been held since its inception. The First Session (1947) and the Second Session (1948) were on Palestine, followed by the Third Session (1961) on Tunisia; many others have followed over the years. Some recent sessions were held like the Session (2005) on the commemoration of the sixtieth anniversary of the liberation of the Nazi concentration camps, Session (2002) on World Summit for Children, Session (2001) on Problem of human immunodeficiency virus/acquired immunodeficiency syndrome (HIV/AIDS) in all its aspects, Session (2001) on Implementation of the outcome of the UN Conference on Human Settlements (Habitat II).

The General Assembly can also meet for emergency special sessions. Under the resolution 377A(V), “Uniting for peace”, adopted by the General Assembly on 3 November 1950, an “emergency special session” can be convened within 24 hours.

Several emergency sessions have been held on illegal Israeli actions